



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2022-23
PRE BOARD EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER II (Set A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

The paper has four sections.

Section A is compulsory- All questions in Section A must be answered.

You must attempt one question from each of the Sections B, C and D and one other question from any section of your choice.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of seven printed pages.

SECTION A

(Attempt all questions from this section)

Question 1

Read the following questions and choose the most appropriate response from the choices given below. (Please do not copy the question – simply write out in correct serial order the appropriate word or phrase.) [16]

- i) Which word has been used in the story “*The Little Match Girl*” to describe the grandmother?
- a) loving
 - b) compassionate
 - c) caring
 - d) optimistic

ii) Why does the caged bird sing?

- a) The only freedom available to the bird is the freedom of singing.
- b) He is a good singer and loves to make everyone hear him across the distant hills.
- c) He cannot fly, therefore, he sings to pass his time inside the cage.
- d) He sings to make the other birds jealous.

iii) What was the nature of Joe Thompson's wife before Maggie's arrival?

- a) She believed in doing something good for others.
- b) She had a soft heart.
- c) She was a woman of saintly temper.
- d) She was a rude, ill-tempered and self – afflicting woman.

iv) What was Jesse Owens' greatest Olympic prize?

- a) The gold medal that he won in the long jump.
- b) The experience that he gained in the Olympics.
- c) The true friendship he formed with Long.
- d) The money that he gained in the games.

v) Who is the poet of *The Patriot*?

- a) Leigh Hunt
- b) David Roth
- c) Robert Browning
- d) Maya Angelou

vi) The little girl in the story '*The Little Match Girl*' struck another match and she found herself sitting under _____.

- a) a hemlock tree
- b) a Christmas tree
- c) a mulberry tree
- d) a banyan tree

vii) The free bird represents the _____.

- a) Anglo- Indians
- b) White Americans
- c) Afro- Americans
- d) Red Indians

viii) “*You should be able to qualify with your eyes closed*”. Who said these words and to whom?

- a) Jesse Owens’ coach to Jesse Owens
- b) Luz Long to Jesse Owens
- c) Jesse Owens to Luz Long
- d) Hitler to Luz Long

ix) How did the narrator’s forehead get injured as mentioned in the poem ‘*The Patriot*’?

- a) By the stones people fling at him.
- b) By tripping and falling in the rain.
- c) By the tight rope cutting his head.
- d) By a sharp knife

x) How did Maggie become a ‘diseased’ person?

- a) From birth, she was disabled.
- b) She had a fall from a window and injured her spine.
- c) She was suffering from a dangerous disease.
- d) She had injured her leg while playing and was unable to walk.

xi) *Shylock: Go, Tubal, and meet me at our synagogue*. What is the meaning of the word ‘synagogue’?

- a) Jewish place of worship
- b) Church
- c) Court of Law
- d) Rialto

xii) Whom did Portia appoint to deliver the letter to Padua?

- a) Bassanio**
- b) Launcelot**
- c) Balthazar**
- d) Lorenzo**

xiii) Name the young lovers whose lives ended tragically because of a misunderstanding caused by the appearance of a lion.

- a) Troilus and Cressida**
- b) Dido and Aeneas**
- c) Pyramus and Thisbe**
- d) Medea and Aeson**

xiv) *Shylock: A Daniel come to judgement! Yea, a Daniel!* Who is referred to as a 'Daniel' here?

- a) Nerissa**
- b) The Duke**
- c) Portia**
- d) Antonio**

xv) How does Lorenzo recognize Portia even before he sees her when the two young women return from Venice?

- a) by the clothes she wears**
- b) by the sound of her voice**
- c) by her perfume**
- d) by her touch**

xvi) Which of the following words best describes Antonio's attitude during the trial?

- a) jealous**
- b) angry**
- c) generous**
- d) resigned**

SECTION B
DRAMA (The Merchant of Venice- Shakespeare)

Question 2

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Bassanio: Here is a letter, lady,
 The paper as the body of my friend,
 And every word in it a gaping wound,
 Issuing life-blood.*

- i) Where is this scene taking place? Who is 'lady'? Who has sent the letter? [3]
- ii) What are contents of the letter? [3]
- iii) Shylock has been persuaded by many to change his mind and forfeit the bond. Who are the people persuading Shylock? What has Jessica heard Shylock say in front of Tubal and Chus regarding Antonio? [3]
- iv) How does Bassanio describe Antonio to Portia? What does Portia ask Bassanio to do to have the bond defaced? [3]
- v) Which casket has Bassanio chosen in this scene? What does he find in that casket? What is your impression of Portia from this scene? Elucidate with textual examples. [4]

Question 3

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Lorenzo: The moon shines bright. In such a night as this,
 When the sweet wind did gently kiss the trees
 And they did make no noise, in such a night
 Troilus methinks mounted the Trojan walls
 And sigh'd his soul toward the Grecian tents.*

- i) Who is Lorenzo speaking to? Which other characters from the classics are mentioned soon after? What happy news does Stephano? [3]
- ii) Lorenzo wants some music to be played to welcome Portia. What example of colts does Lorenzo give to illustrate the power of music? What kind of men should never be trusted according to Lorenzo? [3]
- iii) Portia hears the music from afar and comments :
 'How many things by season seasoned are'
 To their right praise and true perfection!
 What examples does she give in this context? What does Portia want Nerissa to instruct the servants as soon as they reach home? [3]

- iv) What is the reason for the fight between Bassanio and Portia? What justification did Bassanio give soon after to reduce Portia's displeasure? [3]
- v) What good news do Antonio and Lorenzo get at the end of the scene? If you could change the ending of the play, how would you want to end the play and why? [4]

SECTION C
PROSE- SHORT STORIES
(Treasure Trove- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 4

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

A few cold drops fell on their noses and their cheeks and their mouths. The sun faded behind a stir of mist. A wind blew around them.

- i) Who are 'them'? Why have they come here? Which special event was about to happen? [3]
- ii) What had 'them' done in class the day before the special event? Name the state where Margot lived before coming to Venus. [3]
- iii) How was Margot different from 'them'? How did Margot describe the sun to her classmates? [3]
- iv) What did 'them' do when the sun finally shone in the sky? [3]
- v) What did 'them' do to Margot? How did they behave after they set her free? If you were Margot, would you have complained to your teacher against the other students? Give reasons for your answer? [4]

Question 5

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

"The crocodile had no need to hide himself. He came to rest in the glassy shallows, among logs and balanced there on tiptoe on the rippled sand, with only his raised eyes out of the water, and raised nostrils breathing the clean sunny air."

- i) Describe the crocodile. Why did it swallow stones? [3]
- ii) What did the 'big crocodile' feed on? [3]
- iii) How was Sibia dressed? Describe her meal. [3]
- iv) Why does the author say 'But Sibia, in all her life from birth to death, was marked for work'? Where did Sibia accompany her mother everyday? [3]
- v) Why couldn't Sibia make a necklace of 'lal-lal-beegees' for herself? What was the blue bead in reality? Give a suitable character trait of Sibia with suitable justification from the text. [4]

SECTION D
POETRY
(Treasure Trove- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 6

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

*And then my heart with pleasure fills,
And dances with the daffodils.*

- i) Who is 'my'? What was 'my' doing when he had suddenly chanced upon the daffodils? Identify and explain the figure of speech used in this context. [3]
- ii) How does 'my' describe the vast extent of the daffodils? [3]
- iii) How does the poet feel in the company of the daffodils? Why has the word 'gazed' been repeated in the poem? What comparison is being made between the waves and the daffodils? [3]
- iv) Where did 'my' see the daffodils? Which colour has been used to describe the daffodils in the poem? [3]
- v) The poet says "*What wealth the show to me had brought.*" Explain this line with close reference to the change in the mood of the poet when he lies on his couch in a vacant or pensive mood. Name and explain with textual references the theme of the poem. [4]

Question 7

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

*The signal was given, the pistol exploded
And so did the runners on hearing the sound*

- i) What were the runners aiming for? How long had they been training? Which specific race of the 'Games' were they participating in? [3]
- ii) How many athletes were participating in the last race? Describe the spectators around. What happened at the announcement? [3]
- iii) What happened to the youngest athlete? How did he react after the mishap? What was the reason for such a reaction? [3]
- iv) What was the reaction of the other athletes after the mishap? [3]
- v) How did the race end? What was written on the banner? What is one prominent theme of the poem? [4]